

Neurodiversity Concept		
Lesson Date	Lesson Leads	Slides
Day 1	Teacher/counselor	
Logistics		
Materials Needed	Acquired?	Roles and Responsibilities
Paper	o	Lesson Lead: Manage activities and guide discussions throughout the lesson, and ensure students' safety. Students: Participate in activities and discussions.
Crayons	o	
Whiteboard	o	
Whiteboard markers		
Lesson Agenda		
Agenda Item (time)	Notes	
Check-in (2 minutes)	<i>What is something you're really good at?</i> <i>What is something you struggle with?</i> Compare how the different students have different strengths and weaknesses, reflecting the diversity within the class and the world.	
Watch video (4 minutes)	https://youtu.be/ZSTLQk9bB8I	
Analyze and discuss (5 minutes)	Do you learn or think like any of the kids in the video? What about your friends? 15-20% of people, meaning one out of every five or six of your friends are neurodivergent. Is this true? Have you seen this?	
Activity 1 (4 minutes)	Would you rather... Students share their answers to show how people think differently. 4-5 questions, depending on time availability. Example questions below (starting generic and then more specific to learning) 1. Would you rather live in Antarctica or a desert? 2. Would you rather be invisible or read minds? 3. Would you rather read a picture book or watch a video? 4. Would you rather use blocks or a whiteboard to solve a math question?	
Activity (10 minutes)	Drawing our Worlds The teacher will give a prompt, and students will first draw whatever comes to mind. After each round, students will share what they came up with, which will hopefully be very different.	

	1. Draw a house for a dragon 2. Draw 'The Future' (expecting everything from flying cars to a world with more trees) 3. Draw the perfect classroom for you (Bean bags, giant library, outdoor classroom)
Final discussion (5 minutes)	Connecting the activities to the final definition: • Today we played Would You Rather, and we all drew pictures. • The teacher gave everyone the exact same instructions, but no one had the exact same answers or drawings. • Talk to the person next to you about some differences and similarities between their drawings. • Why do you think this student made a drawing like X and another student made a drawing like Y? Is one of them wrong? ○ No, of course not! It's because all of our brains are different. One of you might be great at art, another at puzzles, and so on. <i>This is what neurodiversity is.</i> "Neurodiversity means that all brains are naturally different."

Equality and Fairness (Accommodations)		
Lesson Date	Lesson Leads	Slides
Day 2	Teacher/counselor	
Logistics		
Materials Needed	Acquired?	Roles and Responsibilities
Jenga blocks (as many sets as possible)	o	Lesson Lead: Manage the discussions and activities. Hand out Jenga blocks, form teams, and facilitate discussion while keeping students safe. Students: Engage in discussions and work with their peers throughout the activities. Play responsibly and safely with the blocks.
Differently-leveled flat surfaces like tables	o	
Lesson Agenda		
Agenda Item (time)	Notes	
Check-in (2 minutes)	What does it mean to be fair? Ask students to turn and talk with one another.	
Watch video (3 minutes)	https://youtu.be/Uvoios7frls	
Analyze and discuss (5 minutes)	Ask students about the opening scene with people on different levels. Mention that equity is the same thing as fairness. Ask the following questions to guide their thinking. - Does everyone have an equal block? - Yes, of course - Is it fair for each? - No, it's much harder for the child on the right - This is the difference between equality (the first) and fairness (the second).	
Activity (15 minutes)	Paper Cup Towers Set up: Divide the class into two teams (A and B). Team A builds a stand at a desk. Team B builds while sitting on the floor (this gives them an inherent disadvantage). The game: Give both teams the same number of paper cups (15 each) and the same time (2 minutes) to build the tallest tower possible.	

	<i>Was this activity fair?</i> For 2-3 minutes, have students share new ideas to make the game fairer. Redo the activity using the new ideas the students come up with to make it fairer (e.g., more cups for Team B, more time, or a lower building surface).
Final discussion (5 minutes)	Stress that equal conditions (2 minutes, 15 cups) did not give a fair result. The inherent height imbalance required equity, not equality ⇒ counterbalancing, unequal conditions can be used to create equal results. Ask students to identify and reflect on real-world instances where equality and equity are at play. Some examples: Band-Aids: Giving everyone one Band-Aid is equal, but giving a large Band-Aid to a big cut and a small Band-Aid to a tiny cut is equitable. School lunch: Giving every kid the same tray is equal, but giving extra food to a hungry kid and a different meal to a kid with allergies is equitable. Watching a parade: Giving everyone the same size box to stand on is equal, but giving a taller box to a short kid and no box to a tall kid is equitable. Glasses: Giving every kid the same prescription glasses is equal, but giving each kid the prescription their own eyes need is equitable.

Communication		
Lesson Date	Lesson Leads	Slides
Day 3	Teacher/counselor	
Logistics		
Materials Needed	Acquired?	Roles and Responsibilities
Cards for the Taboo game	o	Lesson Lead: Set up the game cards, manage activities and guide discussions throughout the lesson, and handle safety. Students: Participate in activities and discussions.
Lesson Agenda		
Agenda Item (time)	Notes	
Check-in (2 minutes)	Everyone stays quiet (1 min) and plays the silent game until someone says something. Then talk about how weird it was to have no one speak, and introduce the need for clear communication.	
Watch video (9 minutes)	https://youtu.be/79HMPQj55yc Remind students that each diagnosis is just an example of neurodivergence; neurodivergence is a broader category that encompasses all of these more specific issues.	
Analyze and discuss (5 minutes)	Talk about the dishes: Question: In the video, the parents tell the child to wash the dishes, "Because I said so." How did it make the child feel? Follow-up: When the parents explained why, did it make the child more or less likely to help? Why? The speaker says their brain is like a "truth-teller" that says exactly what they meant. (e.g., saying "it's fine" when they are actually upset) Prompt: Autistic people often prefer "direct" talk. Is being direct (saying exactly what you mean) the same as being mean? How can it actually be a way to be a better friend?	
Activity 1 (4 minutes)	Direct Descriptions with Taboo - Create cards with a Secret Word (e.g., "Apple"). - Below the Secret Word, list 3 "Guessing Words"—these are	

	common, vague hints that are now "Taboo" (forbidden). Example Card: Secret Word: Apple Taboo Hints: "It's a snack," "A teacher likes it," "It is round." The Rules One student is the Describer. They must get the class to guess the Secret Word. They cannot use the Taboo Hints. Instead, they must use Direct/Literal descriptions (facts about what it looks like, what it does, or what it is made of). Good Direct Description: "It is a red fruit that grows on trees. It has a stem on top and is white crunchy inside with tiny black seeds."
Discussion (10 minutes)	Reflecting on the game When you couldn't use the easy hints, did you have to think harder about what the object looks like? To be direct, we have to look at the literal facts... Was it easier to guess when someone gave you a hint like 'it's yummy' or when they gave you a direct fact like 'it is red and crunchy'?
Final discussion (5 minutes)	Connect back to the video: The speaker in the video said neurotypical people sometimes say things in a weird, fuzzy way. Have you ever had a friend say something that confused you because they weren't being direct (e.g., a friend saying "That's totally a nice drawing" in a weird voice—using sarcasm) Conclude with the overarching lesson: There is no single "correct" way to communicate. A supportive, neurodiversity-affirming classroom listens with patience, respect, and openness to all forms of expression.

Applying Concepts		
Lesson Date	Lesson Leads	Slides
Day 4	Teacher/counselor	Need slides for situations
Logistics		
Materials Needed	Acquired?	Roles and Responsibilities
N/A	o	Lesson Lead: Lead the scenario slideshow, guide critical thinking around the difference between choices and support needs, and maintain a supportive, respectful space for classroom discussion. Students: Listen thoughtfully to the situations, participate actively in analysis, and view challenges from a classmate's perspective
Lesson Agenda		
Agenda Item (time)	Notes	
Check-in (2 minutes)	Presenting one micro-situation: A friend is wearing sunglasses inside the classroom. Is that a 'fashion choice' or a 'support need'? What is the difference between wanting to wear them and needing to wear them?	
Analyze and discuss (6 minutes)	Provide the following examples and, for each, ask students to give possible reasons as to why a student might do that. Headphones: A student is wearing headphones inside the classroom. Wearing headphones helps them block out loud noises so they can focus on their work. Chewing gum: A student is chewing gum in class. Chewing gum helps them stay calm and sit still during a long lesson. Sitting on a bumpy cushion: A student is sitting on a bumpy cushion in their chair. Sitting on the cushion helps them feel where their body is, so they stop wiggling. Typing instead of writing by hand: A student is typing on a tablet instead of writing with a pencil. Typing helps them get their ideas down when their hands get tired easily. Leaving the room during a lesson: A student leaves the classroom for	

	five minutes during math. Stepping out helps them take a break and avoid feeling overwhelmed. Using a fidget toy: A student is squeezing a small fidget toy under their desk. Using the toy helps them listen better because their hands have something to do. Wearing sunglasses inside: A student is wearing sunglasses inside the classroom. Wearing sunglasses helps them because the bright lights give them a headache. Standing at their desk instead of sitting: A student stands at their desk while others sit. Standing helps their bodies feel ready to learn rather than tired and floppy.
Activity (20 minutes)	Teachers will go over different situation cards that are on a provided slideshow <i>Make a slideshow for the different situations listed here and other situations that are deemed fit</i> Noise Sensitivity During art time, the classroom gets loud. One student covers their ears and looks upset. • What might be bothering them? • How could classmates help? Possible supportive solutions: • Speak more quietly • Offer headphones • Let the student move to a quieter space Different Communication Style A student answers questions very directly and doesn't always say "please" or "thank you." • Does that mean they are trying to be rude? • How could classmates respond kindly? Possible solutions: • Ask questions calmly • Give them time to explain • Assume good intentions Movement Needs A student stands up and walks around during a long lesson. • Why might someone need to move? • What could help them learn? Possible solutions: • Allow short movement breaks • Offer a fidget tool • Continue working nearby

	Group Work Challenge A student wants to work alone instead of in a group. • Why might group work feel hard? • How can classmates include them respectfully? Possible solutions: • Offer smaller tasks • Let them contribute in a different way • Respect their preference while still including them
Final discussion (5 minutes)	Ask the following questions and arrive at the following conclusions. What did you notice about these situations? (Some things that look like "bad behavior" might actually be support needs.) How can we tell if something is a choice or a need? (Needs help someone learn, focus, or feel safe. Choices are just for fun.) What should you do if you see a classmate doing something you don't understand? (Don't laugh. Don't copy. Ask kindly. Assume good intentions.) How does this connect to fairness vs. equality? (Fair doesn't mean everyone acts the same. Fair means everyone gets what they need.) Close: Next time you see someone doing something different, ask yourself: Is that a choice or a need?

Commitment to Neurodiversity Acceptance		
Lesson Date	Lesson Leads	Slides
Day 5	Teacher/counselor	
Logistics		
Materials Needed	Acquired?	Roles and Responsibilities
Paper	o	Lesson Lead: Lead discussions and guide students to key topics and ideas. Manage the activity by giving instructions and answering questions or otherwise supporting students Students: Answer questions when prompted and engage meaningfully in the discussions. Put in good effort on the art project.
Crayons	o	
Whiteboard	o	
Lesson Agenda		
Agenda Item (time)	Notes	
Check-in (2 minutes)	Ask students to reflect on their week so far and share their favorite lessons, activities, or discussions. Introduce the topic of committing to neurodiversity acceptance in our classroom.	
Watch video (5 minutes)	(Start at this time, skip intro)	
Analyze and discuss (5 minutes)	Reflection: How do small acts of kindness show that we accept different brains? Can anyone share a time they felt supported by a friend this week?	
Activity 1 (4 minutes)	Students help write 4-6 classroom stories about inclusion and respect. Closing reflection: discuss how small actions can create a ripple effect in the school community.	
Activity (10 minutes)	Final Art Project: Draw out some way that you can help a peer out. Think of unique ways and things that we’ve discussed in class over the last week.	
Final discussion (5 minutes)	Ask students to talk about their favorite lessons from the week. While they discuss , collect the images, and put them together into a loose collage that students can look at. Post-lesson: Tape up or otherwise finalize the collage so parents can view it, or feature it elsewhere.	